

**PERFECT WOMEN**

Let's Do It Together

# BASIC GYM PROGRAM

## 8-Week Strength Plan

with Coach Tammy



**4 GYM  
SESSIONS /  
WEEK**



**PROGRESSIVE  
OVERLOAD**



**2 WALKS  
ENCOURAGED**



**STRONGER WEEK BY WEEK**



# PROGRAM AT A GLANCE

8 weeks • 4 gym sessions per week

4

GYM SESSIONS / WEEK

35-45

MINUTES / SESSION

2

WALKS ENCOURAGED

## YOUR WEEKLY STRUCTURE

DAY 1

Lower Body A

DAY 2

Upper Body A

DAY 3

Lower Body B + Core

DAY 4

Upper Body B + Full Body

## EXAMPLE WEEK

MON

Lower Body A

TUE

Upper Body A

WED

Walk / recovery

THU

Lower Body B + Core

FRI

Rest

SAT

Upper Body B + Full Body

SUN

Walk / recovery

## FLEXIBLE SCHEDULE

Move the days around to suit your week. Keep four gym sessions and two walks where possible; avoid stacking two hard lower-body days back-to-back.

# PROGRESSIVE OVERLOAD

Get a little stronger over time

Progressive overload means gradually asking your muscles to do slightly more. In this program the main method is simple: master 3 x 12 with good form, then increase the weight by the smallest sensible amount.

## 1 START AT A COMFORTABLE WEIGHT

Choose a load that allows 12 good reps. The last 2-3 reps should feel challenging.

## 2 OWN 3 X 12

Stay at that weight until all three sets of 12 are clean and controlled.

## 3 INCREASE SLIGHTLY

Move to the next sensible dumbbell or machine increment.

## 4 BUILD BACK TO 12

After increasing, 8-10 good reps is fine. Keep the new weight and build back toward 12.

### SIMPLE DECISION RULE

Can't reach 12 cleanly

Keep the same weight or reduce slightly.

3 x 12 is hard but clean

Perfect. Stay at this weight.

3 x 12 feels comfortable

Increase the weight slightly next time.

### LOG YOUR WEIGHTS

If you do not record the weights, it is easy to repeat the same workout for eight weeks without actually progressing.

# GYM GUIDELINES

Keep it simple and consistent

1

## WARM-UP

5 minutes on a treadmill, bike or cross trainer.

2

## SETS & REPS

3 sets of 12 unless the workout says otherwise.

3

## REST

60-75 seconds between working sets.

4

## CHOOSE THE RIGHT WEIGHT

The final 2-3 reps should feel challenging, but your form must stay good.

5

## GOOD FORM

Move with control. Use a range of movement you can own.

6

## LISTEN TO YOUR BODY

Muscle effort is expected. Sharp pain is not.

7

## WALKING

Add two 30-40 minute walks each week where possible.

8

## MISSED SESSION

Do not double up hard sessions to catch up. Continue with the next sensible workout.

The program should feel challenging, not chaotic. Focus on controlled reps, steady progress and showing up for the next session.

# 8-WEEK PROGRESSION

## WEEKS 1-2

### LEARN THE MOVEMENTS

- Week 1: 2 sets x 12 reps while learning
- Week 2: 2-3 sets x 12 reps if controlled
- Use manageable weights and own the form

- Week 1 may be 2 x 12 while learning

## WEEKS 3-4

### BUILD CONSISTENCY

- Complete 3 sets x 12 reps
- Improve control and range
- Increase only when 12 reps feel comfortable

- Complete 3 x 12

## WEEKS 5-6

### GET STRONGER

- Use 3 sets x 12 reps
- Several lifts should now be heavier than Week 1
- Do not chase load at the expense of technique

## WEEKS 5-6

### GET STRONGER

## WEEKS 7-8

### FINISH STRONG

- Keep 3 sets x 12 reps
- Keep progressing where appropriate
- Compare Week 8 loads with Week 1

SETS RULE: WEEK 1 = 2 SETS • WEEK 2 = 2-3 SETS • WEEKS 3-8 = 3 SETS

## WEEKS 7-8

### FINISH STRONG

- Keep progressing where appropriate
- Compare Week 8 loads with Week 1
- Notice confidence, stability and control

## WHAT PROGRESS CAN LOOK LIKE



More weight for the same 12 reps



Better range of movement



Better balance and stability



Same weight feels easier and more controlled

# LOWER BODY A

12 REPS / SET

Day 1 • legs and glutes

SETS BY WEEK: WEEK 1 = 2 SETS • WEEK 2 = 2-3 SETS • WEEKS 3-8 = 3 SETS

6 EXERCISES

3 x 12

12 REPS

WEIGHT USED

1

## LEG PRESS

Feet shoulder-width. Lower with control. Do not lock the knees.

12 REPS

3 x 12

WEIGHT: \_\_\_\_\_

2

## GOBLET SQUAT

Hold one dumbbell at chest height. Sit down and back; keep chest up.

12 REPS

3 x 12

WEIGHT: \_\_\_\_\_

3

## SEATED LEG CURL

Sit tall. Curl smoothly and squeeze the hamstrings.

12 REPS

3 x 12

WEIGHT: \_\_\_\_\_

4

## LEG EXTENSION

Lift with control. Do not swing the weight.

12 REPS

3 x 12

WEIGHT: \_\_\_\_\_

12 REPS

5

## HIP THRUST / GLUTE BRIDGE

Drive hips up and squeeze the glutes at the top.

3 x 12

WEIGHT: \_\_\_\_\_

6

## STANDING CALF RAISE

Rise onto the toes, pause, then lower slowly.

3 x 12

WEIGHT: \_\_\_\_\_

THE NUMBER NEXT TO EACH EXERCISE IS THE TARGET REPS PER SET

### PROGRESS

Add weight only when all sets of 12 are controlled.

### WARM-UP

5 min light cardio

### REST

60-75 sec

### PROGRESS

Add weight only when 3 x 12 is controlled

# UPPER BODY A

12 REPS / SET

Day 2 • back, chest, shoulders and arms

SETS BY WEEK: WEEK 1 = 2 SETS • WEEK 2 = 2-3 SETS • WEEKS 3-8 = 3 SETS

6 EXERCISES

3 x 12

12 REPS

EQUIPMENT USED

1

## LAT PULLDOWN

Pull toward the upper chest. Drive the elbows down.

12 REPS

3 x 12

WEIGHT: \_\_\_\_\_

2

## SEATED CHEST PRESS

Press straight forward under control. Do not lock the elbows.

12 REPS

3 x 12

WEIGHT: \_\_\_\_\_

3

## SEATED CABLE ROW

Pull the elbows back and squeeze the shoulder blades.

12 REPS

3 x 12

WEIGHT: \_\_\_\_\_

4

## DUMBBELL SHOULDER PRESS

Start at shoulder height. Press overhead without arching the back.

12 REPS

3 x 12

WEIGHT: \_\_\_\_\_

5

## DUMBBELL BICEPS CURL

Keep elbows close to the body. Do not swing.

3 x 12

WEIGHT: \_\_\_\_\_

6

## CABLE TRICEPS PUSHDOWN

Keep upper arms still and straighten the elbows under control.

3 x 12

WEIGHT: \_\_\_\_\_

THE NUMBER NEXT TO EACH EXERCISE IS THE TARGET REPS PER SET

### PROGRESS

Add weight only when all sets of 12 are controlled.

### WARM-UP

5 min light cardio

### REST

60-75 sec

### PROGRESS

Add weight only when 3 x 12 is controlled

# LOWER BODY B + CORE

REPS / SET

• hinge, single-leg work, glutes and core

SETS BY WEEK: WEEK 1 = 2 SETS • WEEK 2 = 2-3 SETS • WEEKS 3-8 = 3 SETS

7 EXERCISES

3 x 12

12 REPS

EQUIPMENT USED

1

## DUMBBELL ROMANIAN DEADLIFT

3 x 12

WEIGHT: \_\_\_\_\_

Push the hips back, keep the spine long and load the hamstring

12 / SIDE

2

## REVERSE LUNGE

3 x 12 each

WEIGHT: \_\_\_\_\_

Step back under control. Push through the front foot to stand.

12 REPS

3

## HIP ABDUCTION MACHINE

3 x 12

WEIGHT: \_\_\_\_\_

Open the knees under control. Avoid bouncing the stack.

12 REPS

4

## HIP ADDUCTION MACHINE

3 x 12

WEIGHT: \_\_\_\_\_

Bring the legs together under control.

12 / SIDE

5

## GLUTE KICKBACK

3 x 12 each

WEIGHT: \_\_\_\_\_

Keep the pelvis stable and drive the leg back with the glute.

12 TOTAL

6

## DEAD BUG

3 x 12 total

WEIGHT: \_\_\_\_\_

Extend opposite arm and leg while keeping the lower back controlled.

30-45 SEC

7

## STANDARD PLANK

3 x 30-45 sec

WEIGHT: \_\_\_\_\_

THE NUMBER NEXT TO EACH EXERCISE IS THE TARGET REPS PER SET

### PROGRESS

Add weight only when all sets of 12 are controlled.

### WARM-UP

5 min light cardio

### REST

60-75 sec

### PROGRESS

Add weight only when 3 x 12 is controlled

# UPPER BODY B + FULL BODY

REPS / SET

• upper body plus one full-body movement

SETS BY WEEK: WEEK 1 = 2 SETS • WEEK 2 = 2-3 SETS • WEEKS 3-8 = 3 SETS

7 EXERCISES

3 x 12

12 REPS

EQUIPMENT USED

1

## ASSISTED PULL-UP OR LAT PULLDOWN

Choose the version that lets you control the full set.

12 REPS

3 x 12

WEIGHT: \_\_\_\_\_

2

## INCLINE DUMBBELL CHEST PRESS

Keep shoulder blades supported and press smoothly.

12 / SIDE

3 x 12

WEIGHT: \_\_\_\_\_

3

## ONE-ARM DUMBBELL ROW

Brace the torso and pull the elbow toward the hip.

12 REPS

3 x 12 each

WEIGHT: \_\_\_\_\_

4

## DUMBBELL LATERAL RAISE

Use a light weight. Lift to about shoulder height.

12 REPS

3 x 12

WEIGHT: \_\_\_\_\_

5

## DUMBBELL SQUAT TO PRESS

Stand strongly from the squat before pressing overhead.

12 REPS

3 x 12

WEIGHT: \_\_\_\_\_

6

## CABLE BICEPS CURL

Keep elbows close and use a controlled range.

12 REPS

3 x 12

WEIGHT: \_\_\_\_\_

7

## CABLE TRICEPS PUSHDOWN

3 x 12

WEIGHT: \_\_\_\_\_

THE NUMBER NEXT TO EACH EXERCISE IS THE TARGET REPS PER SET

### PROGRESS

Add weight only when all sets of 12 are controlled.

### WARM-UP

5 min light cardio

### REST

60-75 sec

### PROGRESS

Add weight only when 3 x 12 is controlled

# PROGRESS TRACKER

Record your weight or machine setting

## DAY 1

| EXERCISE                  | W1    | W4    | W6    | W8    |
|---------------------------|-------|-------|-------|-------|
| Leg Press                 | _____ | _____ | _____ | _____ |
| Goblet Squat              | _____ | _____ | _____ | _____ |
| Seated Leg Curl           | _____ | _____ | _____ | _____ |
| Leg Extension             | _____ | _____ | _____ | _____ |
| Hip Thrust / Glute Bridge | _____ | _____ | _____ | _____ |
| Standing Calf Raise       | _____ | _____ | _____ | _____ |

## DAY 2

| EXERCISE                | W1    | W4    | W6    | W8    |
|-------------------------|-------|-------|-------|-------|
| Lat Pulldown            | _____ | _____ | _____ | _____ |
| Seated Chest Press      | _____ | _____ | _____ | _____ |
| Seated Cable Row        | _____ | _____ | _____ | _____ |
| Dumbbell Shoulder Press | _____ | _____ | _____ | _____ |
| Dumbbell Biceps Curl    | _____ | _____ | _____ | _____ |
| Cable Triceps Pushdown  | _____ | _____ | _____ | _____ |

## DAY 3

| EXERCISE                   | W1    | W4    | W6    | W8    |
|----------------------------|-------|-------|-------|-------|
| Dumbbell Romanian Deadlift | _____ | _____ | _____ | _____ |
| Reverse Lunge              | _____ | _____ | _____ | _____ |
| Hip Abduction Machine      | _____ | _____ | _____ | _____ |
| Hip Adduction Machine      | _____ | _____ | _____ | _____ |
| Glute Kickback             | _____ | _____ | _____ | _____ |
| Dead Bug                   | _____ | _____ | _____ | _____ |
| Standard Plank             | _____ | _____ | _____ | _____ |

## DAY 4

| EXERCISE                         | W1    | W4    | W6    | W8    |
|----------------------------------|-------|-------|-------|-------|
| Assisted Pull-Up OR Lat Pulldown | _____ | _____ | _____ | _____ |
| Incline Dumbbell Chest Press     | _____ | _____ | _____ | _____ |
| One-Arm Dumbbell Row             | _____ | _____ | _____ | _____ |
| Dumbbell Lateral Raise           | _____ | _____ | _____ | _____ |
| Dumbbell Squat to Press          | _____ | _____ | _____ | _____ |
| Cable Biceps Curl                | _____ | _____ | _____ | _____ |
| Cable Triceps Pushdown           | _____ | _____ | _____ | _____ |

Use the same machine setup where possible so the comparison means something. Progress can also be better range, control or confidence - not only more weight.

PERFECT WOMEN

Let's Do It Together

# EXERCISE GUIDE 1-6

Start + finish positions • reps • one clear cue

## Leg Press

3x12

Start



Finish



Feet shoulder-width. Lower with control. Do not lock the knees.

## Goblet Squat

3x12

Start



Finish



Hold the dumbbell at your chest. Sit down and back, keep your chest up.

## Seated Leg Curl

3x12

Start



Finish



Keep your hips against the pad. Control the movement.

## Leg Extension

3x12

Start



Finish



Sit tall, hold the handles. Lift with control, do not swing.

## Hip Thrust / Glute Bridge

3x12

Start



Finish



Drive through your heels. Squeeze your glutes at the top.

## Standing Calf Raise

3x12

Start



Finish



Keep your body tall. Rise up, pause, then lower with control.

STRONGER WOMEN ♥ HAPPIER LIVES

## EXERCISE GUIDE 7-10

Start + finish positions • reps • one clear cue

### Lat Pulldown 3x12

Start



Finish



Pull toward the upper chest. Drive the elbows down.

### Chest Press Machine 3x12

Start



Finish



Press straight forward with control. Do not lock the elbows.

### Seated Cable Row 3x12

Start



Finish



Sit tall. Pull the elbows back and squeeze the shoulder blades.

### Dumbbell Shoulder Press 3x12

Start



Finish



Start at shoulder height. Press overhead without arching your back.

### USE THE WORKOUT PAGES FOR THE PLAN

These cards are quick visual references for setup, start/finish position and the main technique cue.